



Glossary

alga Simple, plant-like life form mostly found in water, including the ocean. Algae can be tiny and too small for us to see, or very large, such as seaweeds

amphibian Animal with a backbone that usually spends part of its life in water and the rest on land. It usually develops from an egg to a larva, and then into an adult. Frogs and newts are examples of amphibians

bulb Fat, fleshy part of some plants that is buried underground and acts as a food store

camouflage Colour or pattern that disguises an animal where it lives, to help it hide from attackers

carnivorous Description of organisms that eat meat

cell Smallest building block from which a living thing is made. Some tiny life forms have only a single cell, such as bacteria, many algae, and amoebas. Large animals or plants may have trillions of cells

conifer Tree with thin, needle-like leaves, and tough cones that contain seeds. Most conifers keep their needles all year round. Fir and pine trees are conifers

coral reef Habitat found mainly in warm, shallow seas. It is made from the rock-hard skeletons of billions of tiny animals, called corals

crystal Shape and structure in which a mineral grows

echolocation Using sound to work out how far away an object is by listening for the echo from a call. Dolphins and many bats use echolocation to find their way around and to identify food

element Basic substance from which everything is made, including living things and objects. Elements can be solid, liquid, or gas, and they may change between these different states. Oxygen, iron, carbon, and gold are all examples of elements

endangered When an animal becomes very rare in the wild. If we do not do something to help, the animal might disappear forever and go extinct

fossil Hardened remains of organisms that lived millions of years ago. Fossils can be of body parts, such as bones, or things made by life forms, such as footprints

frond Leaf of a fern. It often has delicate, feathery edges

fungus Life form that usually feeds on rotting or dead things. Mushrooms and mould are fungi

gemstone Precious stone or piece of rock that has been cut and polished to make it shine

gills Organs used to breathe underwater. Fish, crabs, lobsters, shrimp, and some amphibians have gills

habitat Place where animals, plants, and other living things are found. Habitats can be on land or in water. Many species live only in a particular habitat

igneous rock Rock made from cooling hot, liquid magma inside the Earth, or lava that has erupted from volcanoes

insect Animal with three pairs of legs and a body in three sections. These are the head, the thorax (in the middle), and the abdomen (at the back). Many insects also have two pairs of wings

invertebrate Animal with no backbone, such as insects, spiders, crabs, and lobsters

lungs Organs used to breathe air on land

mammal Animal with a backbone, which has warm blood and, fur or hair. Nearly all mammals give birth to live young, though some unusual species lay eggs. All mother mammals feed their young milk

metamorphic rock Rock made from another rock under massive heat and pressure, often deep underground

meteorite Chunk of rock that has travelled through space and crashed into a planet, such as the Earth

microscope Scientific instrument that magnifies objects, allowing us to see things too small for our eyes. They can have a camera to take images of microscopic life